KUN LEE

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ACADEMIC POSITIONS

Tony Atkinson Fellow, LIS Cross-National Data Center; Research Associate, Luxembourg Institute of Socio-Economic Research (LISER) — 2024-Present

Research Affiliate, Department of Social Policy and Intervention (DSPI), University of Oxford, UK — 2025-Present

Visiting Researcher, Institute for Social Development and Policy Research, Seoul National University, Republic of Korea — August 2025

EDUCATION

DPhil Social Policy, University of Oxford, UK — 2020-2024

MSc Comparative Social Policy (*Distinction*), University of Oxford, UK — 2018-2019

BA Social Welfare & Economics (*Summa Cum Laude*), Seoul National University, Republic of Korea — 2012-2018

Visiting Research & Exchange

Stone Center for Inequality Dynamics, University of Michigan, Ann Arbor, MI, USA (4 months, Host: Fabian Pfeffer) — 2024

Finnish Centre for Pensions, Helsinki, Finland (1 month, Host: Kati Kuitto) — 2023

Humboldt University of Berlin Germany (3 months, Host: Anette Fasang) — 2023

University of Mannheim, Germany (4 months, Host: Bernhard Ebbinghaus) — 2022

University College London, UK (Arts & Sciences, International Exchange) — 2016-2017

PUBLICATIONS

Peer-Reviewed Journal Articles (* Corresponding author)

Lee, K. & Ebbinghaus, B. (2025). 'Converging or unequal retirement patterns? Late working lives, retirement trajectories, and pension income in Germany over three decades of cohorts', *Social Forces*

Oh, J., Son, S. & **Lee, K.*** (2025). 'Exclusion from a 'mandatory' pension scheme: Late-stage dropouts from the National Pension System in South Korea', *Journal of the Economics of Ageing*, 100578.

Kim, K. & **Lee, K.** (2025). 'Intra-couple allocation of paid and unpaid work, allocation perceptions, and life satisfaction in South Korea: An analysis based on the 'equitable specialization' framework', *Korean Journal of Social Welfare*, 77(2), 213-237 [in Korean]

Lee, K. (2024). 'Varying Effects of Public Pensions: Pension Spending and Old-age

Employment under Different Pension Regimes.' *Journal of European Social Policy*, 34(1).
- JESP/ESPAnet Doctoral Researcher Prize 2023 (Best Paper)
- SASE 2023 Early Career Workshop Award

Lee, K. (2022). 'Old-age Poverty in a Pension Latecomer: The Impact of Basic Pension Expansions in South Korea', *Social Policy & Administration*, 56(7), 1022-1040.

Lee, K. & Zaidi, A. (2020). 'How policy configurations matter: a critical look into pro-natal policy in South Korea based on a gender and family framework', *International Journal of Sociology & Social Policy*, 40(7/8), 589-606.

Book Chapters

Kuitto, K. & **Lee, K.** (2025). 'How to make extending working lives in ageing welfare states socially sustainable', in M. Vaalavuo, K. Nelson & K. Kuitto (eds.), *Social Sustainability in Ageing Welfare States*, Cheltenham, UK: Edward Elgar.

Ebbinghaus, B. & **Lee, K.** (2023). 'From early retirement to later exit from work: shifting towards active ageing', in D. Clegg & N. Durazzi (eds.), *Handbook of Labour Market Policy in Advanced Democracies*, Cheltenham, UK: Edward Elgar.

Selected Working Papers

Old and new welfare states retaining older workers in the face of crisis: The case of COVID-19 in Europe (single author; Revise & Resubmit, *Socio-Economic Review*).

Context matters: The role of family policies shaping fertility and women's labor force participation across policy regimes (with Eunho Cha & Stacie Tao; *under review*)

Welfare states and wealth inequality: Pension systems, the public-private mix, and augmented wealth in old age (with Javier Olivera & Philippe Van Kerm)

Threats of AI? Workers' perceptions of technological change and precautionary pension savings (with Ludivine Martin & Thuc-Uyen Nguyen-Thi; *under review*)

A fragile social contract: The politics of an unpopular pension reform in South Korea (with Dong-kyun Im)

Beyond Beveridge and Bismarck: A new typology of pension systems for the 21st century (with Bernhard Ebbinghaus and Daria Frost)

AWARDS, GRANTS & FELLOWSHIPS

Social Policy Association Travel Grant (EASP-SPA Joint Annual Conference)	2025
KFAS-Salzburg Global Fellowship	2024
SustAgeable Consortium Project Grant, Helsinki, Finland	2023
Horowitz Foundation for Social Policy Doctoral Dissertation Grant	2023
JESP/ESPAnet Doctoral Researcher Prize (Best Paper)	2023
SASE Early Career Workshop Award	2023
German Academic Exchange Service (DAAD) Short-term Research Grant	2022

ICPSR Summar Program Scholarship for Public Administration, Public Policy, and Public Affairs, University of Michigan, Ann Arbor, MI, USA	2022
Centenary Scholarship, DSPI, University of Oxford, UK	2020
Korea Foundation for Advanced Studies (KFAS) Doctoral Fellowship	2020
Republic of Korea Government Scholarship for Study Overseas	2018

INVITED LECTURES

'Panel Data Analysis using LIS data', Guest Lectures

- *LIS Summar Workshop*, Luxembourg, 2 July 2025 & July 2026 (scheduled)
- *MSc International Relations and Diplomacy*, Leiden University, 19 February 2026

'The Luxembourg Income and Wealth Study: Introduction and Applications to Comparative Inequality Research', Special Lecture at the Annual Symposium of the *Korean Inequality Research Network*, Seoul, Korea, 16 July 2025

'Introduction to the South Korean Pension System: History, Current State and Challenges', *ETK Research Seminar*, Finnish Centre for Pensions, Helsinki, 4 October 2023

'Analyzing Panel Data in Comparative Research', Guest lecture for *Comparative Research Methods*, University of Mannheim, Germany

SEMINARS/WORKSHOPS

'Welfare states and wealth inequality: Pension systems, the public-private mix, and augmented wealth in old age'

- *CBS Seminar*, Herman Deleeck Centre for Social Policy, University of Antwerp, 15 May 2025
- *(LIS)^{2}ER-SHARE Workshop: Pensions and Old-age Well-being*, 27-28 November 2025

'Threats of AI? How workers perceive and respond to technological change in the workplace'

- *East Asian Political Economy Workshop*, King's College London, 26 June 2025
- *Netspar International Pension Workshop,* Leiden, 18 June 2025

'Convergence or continued stratification? Late working lives, retirement trajectories, and pension income in Germany'

- *Sequence Analysis Association* Webinar Series, 17 October 2024 (online)
- *LISER Seminar Series*, Luxembourg, 7 November 2024

'The Impact of Basic Pension Expansions on Older People's Income and Poverty in South Korea', *BSA Social Statistics Group* Brown Bag (online), 30 September 2021

CONFERENCE PRESENATIONS

World Inequality Conference, Paris, France, June 4-6 (scheduled)	2026
PAA Annual Meeting, St. Louis, MO, USA, May 6-9 (scheduled)	
In_equality Conference, Konstanz, Germany, April 14-17 (scheduled)	
19th Winter School on Inequality & Social Welfare Theory, Canazei, Italy, January 6-9	
ISI Wealth Inequality Conference, Munich, Germany, October 9-11	2025

Research on East Asian Demography & Inequality, Seoul, Korea, July 18-19
Social Policy Association Annual Conference, York, UK, July 2-4
PAA Annual Meeting, Washington DC, USA, April 11-13
ISA-RC28 Spring Meeting, Milan, Italy, March 25-27
Comparative Economic Inequality Conference, Luxembourg, February 27-28

Annual ESPAnet Conference, Tampere, Finland, August 28-30 2024
EASP-FISS Joint Annual Conference, Kyoto, Japan, June 13-14
PAA Annual Meeting, Columbus, OH, USA, April 17-20 (Poster)

Annual ESPAnet Conference, Warsaw, Poland, September 7-9 2023
ISA-RC28 Summer Meeting, Ann Arbor, MI, USA, August 17-20 (Poster)
SASE Annual Conference, Rio de Janeiro, Brazil, July 20-22
Social Policy Association Annual Conference, Nottingham, UK, July 5-7
ISA-RC28 Spring Meeting, Paris, France, May 24-26
ESPAnet PhD Workshop, Berlin, Germany, March 16-17

ESA-RN26 Mid-term Conference, Berlin, Germany, October 7-8 2022
Annual ESPAnet Conference, Vienna, Austria, September 14-16
FISS Annual Conference, Sigtuna, Sweden, June 6-7

Annual ESPAnet Conference, online, September 1-3 2021
BSA Work, Employment & Society Conference, online, August 25-27
EASP-FISS Joint Annual Conference, online, July 2-4

EASP Annual Conference, Taipei, Taiwan, July 2-3 2019

TEACHING

University of Oxford, Oxford, UK

Social Policy (Undergraduate) – *Seminar Leader* Fall 2023; 2021-2022

Quantitative Analysis (Postgraduate) – *Teaching Assistant* Fall 2023

Training for Advanced Teaching & Learning, Higher Education Academy (UK Professional Standards Framework) Winter/Spring 2022

University of Mannheim, Mannheim, Germany

Reform Dynamics in European Welfare States (Undergraduate) – *Co-Instructor* (with Bernhard Ebbinghaus) Spring 2023

SERVICE TO THE PROFESSION

Journal Referee: Ageing & Society, Applied Economics, Asian Social Work & Policy Review, International Journal of Social Welfare, International Journal of Sociology & Social Policy, Humanities & Social Science Communications, Journal of Aging & Social Policy, Journal of the Economics of Ageing, Journal of Governmental Studies, Nature Scientific Data, Poverty & Public Policy, Social Policy & Administration, Social Science Research, Socius

Core Member, Pensions Policy Research Group, Social Policy Association UK, 2023-Present

Organizing Committee, (LIS)^{2}ER-SHARE Luxembourg Joint Workshop: "Pensions and Old-age Well-being: Policy Challenges in Ageing Societies", 27-28 November 2025

Organizing Committee, 5th (LIS)^{2}ER Workshop: "Fighting Poverty: Measurement and Policy Challenges", 11-13 December 2024

Organizing Committee, Symposium for Early Researchers in Social Policy & Intervention, Nuffield College, Oxford, 27 May 2022

Co-chair, Young Scholar Session: Labour market and social policy responses to the pandemic, The COVID-19 Public Health and Social Measures (PHSMs) Conference, 6 October 2021

ENGAGEMENT ACTIVITIES

2nd KFAS-Salzburg Global Leadership Initiative: Technology, Growth & Inequality, 2024-25

Contributions to Oxford Supertracker: A global database for COVID-19 policy trackers

Organizing Committee, Oxford-Korea Forum, Wolfson College, Oxford, 12 November 2021

'Myths and Truths of the South Korean National Pension', *Oxford Korean Academic Society* Public Lecture Series, 1 December 2023

'Changes in European Countries', in Sang-jin Han (ed.), *An International Comparative Study on Citizen Participatory Governance Model and Health and Welfare Policies in the COVID-19 Era*, Policy Report for the Ministry of Health and Welfare, Republic of Korea

'Europe's Policy Responses to the Labour Market Crisis during the Pandemic', *Oxford Korean Academic Society* Public Lecture Series, 21 October 2021

Treasurer, Oxford Korean Academic Society, University of Oxford, 2020-21

RESEARCH & WORK EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant, University of Oxford, UK	2021
Research Assistant, Seoul National University, Korea	2021
Research Assistant, King's College London, UK	2020
Administrative Assistant, Seoul National University, Korea	2019-2020
IARU Global Intern, Oxford Institute of Population Ageing, Oxford, UK	2019
Social Work Trainee, Hanwoori Rehabilitation Center, Seoul, Korea	2018
Military Service, National Assembly Police Officer, Seoul, Korea	2014-2015

OTHER SKILLS

Languages: English (fluent), Korean (native)

Statistical Software: R, Stata

REFERENCES

Bernhard Ebbinghaus
Professor & Chair of Macrosociology
University of Mannheim
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Relationship: PhD Supervisor

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Relationship: PhD Supervisor

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